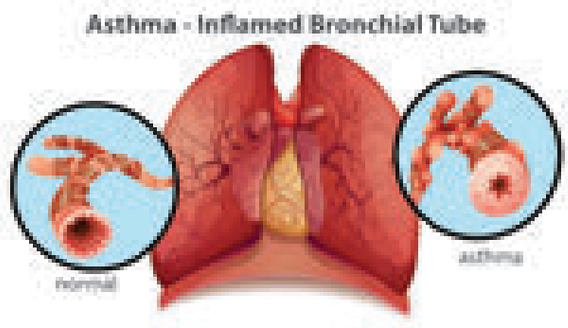
3.4 RESPIRATORY DISORDERS

Asthma

COPD (Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease)



3.4.1 Asthma

Asthma is an inflammatory disease of the airway causing mucosal oedema and increased mucous production.

Causes

- Exposure to indoor and outdoor allergens
- Airway irritant

Risk factors

- Family history of bronchial asthma
- Exposure to airway irritants (weed, pollens, dust, strong odours, smoke)
- Signs and Symptoms:
- Non-Productive cough
- Dyspnea
- Diaphoresis
- Tachycardia
- Tachypnea
- Wheezing
- Cyanosis

Investigations

- Family and occupational history
- Increased esonophil counts
- ABG-Analysis
- Sputum for Culture
- Pulmonary function test

Medical management

- Corticosteroids
- Bronchodilators
- Oxygen therapy
- Nebulization

Nursing Mangement

- Ineffective air way clearance related to inflammation and increased secretion.
  - Increased fluid intake
  - Coughing and breathing exercise
  - Change of position frequently
  - Administer broncho dilator
  - Chest physiotherapy
  - Suctioning
  - Artificial airway if required
- Ineffective breathing pattern related to tachycardia
  - Comfort position to facilitate breathing
  - Administer prescribed cough suppressants and analgesics
  - Monitor ABG
  - Observe signs of hypoxia
- Activity intolerance related to decreased energy
  - Schedule the activity after management
  - Use oxygen as needed
  - Avoid smoking, weight gain and stress which increases the oxygen demand
  - Provide psychological support
  - Calm and quiet environment to reduce anxiety

XII_Nursing_Vocational_Unit 3.indd 67 1/11/2020 2:36:27 PM